

TAHIA ANAN DHIRA

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PROFILE

Economist and social data scientist (MSc Applied Social Data Science, LSE, Distinction; MSS Economics, University of Dhaka) working at the intersection of empirical economics, network analysis, and computational text analysis. Currently Assistant Professor of Economics at the University of Dhaka, with an active research portfolio spanning international trade, migration, environmental economics, and computational social science. Recent projects apply large-scale social-media and international datasets, including more than 8 million YouTube comments, bilateral trade and migration networks, and trade-embodied emissions data, using Python, R, Stata, API-based data collection, NLP, network modelling, and panel econometrics.

COMPUTATIONAL & QUANTITATIVE SKILLS

- Econometrics: panel-data and time-series methods (fixed/random effects, PCSE, FGLS, GMM, ARDL) selected according to data structure — integration order, cross-sectional dependence; structural gravity/PPML estimation; factor analysis (EFA/CFA), principal component analysis, structural equation modelling
- Network analysis: ERGM, STERGM, dynamic and weighted networks, centrality, community detection, core-periphery analysis, block modelling, cluster analysis
- Programming: STATA · Python (pandas, NumPy, NetworkX, Matplotlib, scikit-learn) · R (igraph, statnet, ergm, tergm, stm, networkDynamic, quanteda)
- Data collection & construction: API-based and web-scraped data collection (YouTube Data API v3, Qualtrics); harmonizing and constructing large-scale, multi-source panel datasets from trade, migration, survey, and administrative sources
- Machine learning & NLP: sentiment analysis (VADER), structural topic modelling (STM, BERTopic), applied machine learning; additional training in word embeddings, LDA, Wordfish, and transformer-based text classification (BERT)
- Research workflow: Git/GitHub; Gemini API; reproducible pipelines; data visualization; LaTeX

EDUCATION

MSc in Applied Social Data Science (Distinction) — London School of Economics and Political Science (2023)

Coursework: Social Network Analysis; Quantitative Text Analysis; Applied Machine Learning; Managing and Visualizing Data; Research Design

MSS in Economics (CGPA 3.88/4.00) — University of Dhaka (2017)

BSS in Economics (CGPA 3.94/4.00) — University of Dhaka (2016)

CURRENT RESEARCH MANUSCRIPTS

Gendered Cultural Hierarchies in Social Media Audience Discourse: Evidence from Bangladeshi Artists (*Working paper, 2026*)

- Built scalable Python pipelines using YouTube Data API v3 to collect and process over 8 million multilingual comments
- Developed a human-in-the-loop annotation workflow in which the Gemini API generated preliminary art-category and gender classifications from video titles, followed by manual coding, correction, and validation of the full video corpus
- Applied sentiment analysis (VADER) and structural topic modelling (quanteda/STM) to audience discourse across artists, genders, and artistic categories

Product Reproducibility and International Trade Patterns: Evidence from Cultural Goods (*Under review, 2026*)

- Constructed computational pipelines to harmonize and process bilateral trade data across 190 countries
- Combined structural gravity modelling (PPML) with dynamic network modelling (STERGM) to examine trade-relationship formation, persistence, and trade intensity
- Corresponding author; built reproducible workflows across Python, R, and Git

Global Migration Network and the Geography of Development (*Working paper, 2026*)

- Built a 23-year dynamic panel of directed, weighted bilateral migration networks
- Developed reproducible R workflows for network construction, visualization, and panel data analysis
- Contributed to network model development, core-periphery detection, and manuscript preparation

Rethinking the Income–Emissions Relationship: Evidence from Trade-Embodied CO₂ Emissions Networks (*Submitted, 2026*)

- Built reproducible computational workflows integrating large-scale international trade-embodied emissions and macroeconomic datasets
- Constructed weighted global trade-embodied-emissions networks, computed network metrics and country positions
- Combined network analysis with panel econometrics to examine how development and network position shape domestic and trade-embodied CO₂ emissions
- Corresponding author; built reproducible workflows across Python, R, and Git

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Huque, R., Abdullah, S. M., **Dhira, T. A.**, et al. (2025). Determinants of client satisfaction with health insurance: Evidence using a mixed-method approach from Bangladesh. *SSM - Health Systems*, <https://doi.org/10.1016/J.SSMHS.2025.100058>
- Rahman, M. A., **Dhira, T. A.**, et al. (2022). PHQ-9 validation in Bangladesh. *PLOS ONE*. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0269634>
- **Dhira, T. A.**, Rahman, M. A., et al. (2021). GAD-7 validation in Bangladesh. *PLOS ONE*. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0261590>
- Mehareen, J., Rahman, M. A., **Dhira, T. A.**, et al. (2021). Mental health during COVID-19. *Journal of Affective Disorders Reports*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jadr.2021.100179>

EARLIER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Capstone Project, MSc ASDS, LSE — Friendship Network Formation: Pro-sociality and Personality Type (2023)

- Designed and implemented a behavioural classroom experiment on homophily and friendship network formation
- Estimated Exponential Random Graph Models (ERGMs) to identify structural and attribute-based drivers of network formation

Coursework project, ST445, LSE — Topic-Based Content and Sentiment Analysis of COVID-19 Vaccine Discourse on Reddit (2022–2023)

- Visualized a subreddit-level network in which two subreddits are linked by shared frequent commenters among the 40 most active authors, identifying the most central communities and informing the choice to scope subsequent analysis to the top 20 subreddits
- Contributed to report writing, documentation, and referencing on a project led by a classmate, who collected, processed, and modeled the underlying multi-million-comment corpus

Mental Health of University Students Before and After Online Education (UGC-funded) (2020–2021)

- Cleaned survey data and validated research instruments; contributed to preparation of project reports

Willingness to Pay for Treating Mental vs. Physical Illness (BMRC-funded) (2020–2021)

- Cleaned survey data and contributed to instrument validation and report preparation for a study on adults

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, University of Dhaka (*October 2025 – present*)

Lecturer, Department of Economics, University of Dhaka (*November 2018 – September 2025*)

- Taught 10 undergraduate economics courses; supervised undergraduate dissertations and research projects
- Trained undergraduate and graduate students in STATA; developed computational course materials in Python, and STATA

Lecturer, Department of Economics, East West University (*March 2018 – October 2018*)

AWARDS

- Commonwealth Master's Scholarship (2022)
- Gold Medals for highest CGPA, BSS & MSS Economics, University of Dhaka (2016, 2017)

LANGUAGES

Advanced fluency in English and Bangla